# VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

## CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

# Project Report

Digital Literacy Portfolio

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## Introduction

This project report documents my work as part of the CSE0001 – Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The project is built around the scenario of taking on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, responsible for helping peers navigate the digital world effectively, safely, and professionally.

The project is divided into five tasks, each corresponding to a module of the course. These tasks cover a broad range of digital competencies — from creating a visual infographic and building a professional online presence, to exploring coding platforms, practising formal email communication, and understanding cybercrime and online safety.

All tasks have been completed and organized in a public GitHub repository. This report documents each task in detail, reflects on the learning experience, and demonstrates how the skills acquired will be applied throughout my academic and professional journey.

# Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

## Tool Used

For this task, I used Canva (canva.com), a free browser-based graphic design platform that provides a wide range of templates, icons, and layout options. I chose Canva because it is easy to use without any prior design experience and produces professional-quality visuals.

## What the Design Shows

The infographic is a single-page visual resource designed to help first-year students quickly understand key concepts of Digital Literacy. It covers three main topics:

- What Digital Literacy Is — a simple definition explaining that digital literacy is the ability to use digital tools effectively, safely, and responsibly in academic and everyday life.
- Useful Digital Tools for Students — a curated section highlighting platforms such as Google Workspace, GitHub, Canva, and HackerRank, with brief descriptions of how each tool supports student productivity and learning.
- Safe Internet Practices — a visual checklist of tips including using strong passwords, avoiding unknown links, enabling two-factor authentication, and being mindful of what is shared online.

## Reflection

Creating this infographic was an engaging and practical experience. I used Canva for the first time and was impressed by how quickly I could produce a visually appealing design using its drag-and-drop interface. The most challenging part was deciding how much information to include — infographics need to be concise and visual rather than text-heavy, which required me to summarise concepts clearly. I found the process of converting written knowledge into a visual format particularly interesting, as it forced me to think about how different audiences absorb information. This task gave me a new appreciation for visual communication as a key digital skill.

## Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

### Platforms Set Up

For this task, I created and set up accounts on three professional platforms:

- GitHub (github.com) — A version control and code hosting platform widely used by developers and students. I created a profile README repository containing my name, branch, year, and a brief statement about my learning goals. GitHub will serve as my primary portfolio for all coding projects throughout my degree.
- LinkedIn (linkedin.com) — A professional networking platform used by employers, recruiters, and the academic community. I filled in the Education section with my current degree (B.Tech – CSE Core), institution (VIT Bhopal University), and expected graduation year. LinkedIn will be essential for internship applications and professional networking.
- Kaggle (kaggle.com) — A data science and machine learning community platform. I created an account and explored the beginner datasets and notebooks available. Kaggle will become more useful once I begin learning data science and machine learning in later semesters.

### Future Plans

Over the next four years, I plan to actively use all three platforms. On GitHub, I will push coding assignments, projects, and eventually my final year project to build a visible portfolio. On LinkedIn, I will keep updating my profile with internships, certifications, and achievements as I progress through my degree. On Kaggle, I plan to participate in beginner-level competitions and complete learning tracks once I develop sufficient skills in Python and data analysis. Establishing a strong presence on these platforms from first year will give me a significant advantage when applying for internships and placements in later years.

## Task 3 – Coding and Collaboration Platforms

### Part A – Coding Practice (HackerRank)

For the coding practice component, I created an account on HackerRank (hackerrank.com) and completed a beginner-level challenge. The platform provides a browser-based code editor and automatically tests submitted solutions against predefined test cases. This gave me practical exposure to how competitive programming environments work, and helped me understand the basics of reading input, writing logic, and verifying output in a structured setting.

### Part B – Google Forms Collaboration

I created a Google Form titled 'Digital Literacy Assessment Quiz' with 8 well-structured questions designed to test knowledge and awareness of digital literacy concepts. The form covers the following:

- Question 1 (MCQ): What is the primary purpose of a firewall?
- Question 2 (Rating Scale 1–10): Rate your confidence in identifying a phishing email.
- Question 3 (Multi-select): Which of the following are characteristics of a strong password?
- Question 4 (Ranking 1–5): When evaluating the credibility of an online source, rank which criteria you consider most important.
- Question 5 (Grid): Which social media privacy settings do you regularly review or adjust?
- Question 6 (Rating Scale 1–5): How well do you understand how your digital footprint is managed and used?
- Question 7 (Short Answer): Define 'copyright' in the context of digital content and provide a brief example of fair use.
- Question 8 (MCQ): What is the best definition of 'Cloud Computing'?

The form is linked to a Google Sheet that automatically records and organises all responses. The form link is shared in my GitHub repository README.

### Reflection

This task gave me hands-on experience with two very different but equally important categories of digital tools. HackerRank helped me understand the structure of coding challenges and gave me motivation to practice programming consistently. Google Forms demonstrated how easy it is to create interactive, data-collecting tools that can be used in academic and professional settings. Both platforms are ones I intend to use throughout my degree — HackerRank for regular coding practice, and Google Workspace for collaborative assignments, surveys, and peer assessments.

# Task 4 – Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

## Email 1 – Assignment Extension Request

**Subject: Request for Extension on Assignment Submission**

Dear Professor,

I hope you are doing well. I am writing to request a short extension for the submission of my assignment due to unforeseen circumstances.

I have been working on the assignment, but I require a little more time to complete it to the best of my ability.

I kindly request you to grant me an extension of a few days. I assure you that I will submit the assignment as soon as possible.

Thank you for your understanding.

Yours sincerely,
Gaurang Rai

## Email 2 – Summer Internship Expression of Interest

**Subject: Application for Summer Internship Opportunity**

Dear Sir/Madam,

I hope this message finds you well. I am a first-year B.Tech Computer Science student at VIT Bhopal, and I am writing to express my interest in a summer internship opportunity at your organization.

I am currently developing my skills in programming and have a keen interest in software development and artificial intelligence.

I would be grateful for the opportunity to learn and contribute to your team.

Please let me know if there are any available opportunities or application procedures.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours sincerely,
Gaurang Rai

## Communication Scenario – Reflection

One situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem involves a college student who posted a frustrated rant on a public social media group after receiving a poor grade, directly criticising their professor by name. The post quickly spread across the campus community and reached the faculty. The student faced a formal disciplinary meeting and their relationship with the department was seriously damaged. This situation could have been handled very differently — the student could have privately emailed the professor to request feedback and discuss the grade respectfully, using a calm and professional tone. This case is a clear reminder that impulsive digital communication can have lasting real-world consequences, and that the same professionalism expected in face-to-face communication must be applied online.

## Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

### Case Study

UPI fraud is a common cybercrime in India where attackers trick users into sharing sensitive information such as OTPs or approving fraudulent payment requests.

Typically, the attacker contacts the victim through phone calls, messages, or fake links, pretending to be a bank official, customer support agent, or seller. In many cases, the attacker sends a payment request and convinces the victim that approving it will result in receiving money — while in reality, it deducts money from the victim's account. Sometimes, phishing links are used to collect banking credentials and account details directly.

Students and individuals who are not well acquainted with digital payment systems are the most common targets. The consequences of falling victim to UPI fraud include direct financial loss, significant mental stress, and the misuse of personal data for further fraudulent activities.

This type of fraud highlights the critical importance of digital awareness and careful handling of all online transactions. A simple lack of knowledge about how UPI payment requests work — specifically that approving a request sends money rather than receives it — is enough for an attacker to cause serious harm.

### Prevention Checklist – Stay Safe Online

- Never share your OTP or PIN with anyone, including people claiming to be bank officials.
- Do not approve unknown or unexpected payment requests on any UPI app.
- Use only official banking apps downloaded from verified sources (Google Play Store / Apple App Store).
- Avoid clicking on suspicious links received via SMS, WhatsApp, or email.
- Always verify the caller's identity independently before sharing any personal or financial details.
- Enable transaction alerts and SMS notifications on all your bank accounts and UPI apps.
- Regularly review your bank statements and flag any unrecognised transactions immediately.
- Use strong, unique passwords for all banking and payment apps and enable biometric lock where available.

If you become a victim of cybercrime or online fraud, report it immediately through the following official channels:

- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline Number: 1930 (available 24x7)

## Reflection

What surprised me most while working on this task was how straightforward these scams actually are. I expected cybercrime to involve sophisticated technical attacks, but UPI fraud relies almost entirely on social engineering — manipulating people's trust and their lack of awareness about how payment systems work. The fact that something as simple as not knowing that approving a UPI request means sending money — not receiving it — can lead to serious financial loss was genuinely alarming. One habit I will personally change as a result of this research is to never approve any UPI request from an unknown source, no matter how convincing the explanation sounds, and to always verify transactions through official bank channels before acting.

## Conclusion

This Digital Literacy project has been a genuinely valuable learning experience. Across the five tasks, I have developed practical skills that go well beyond the classroom — from designing visual content and setting up professional online profiles, to communicating formally via email and understanding the real digital threats that exist in everyday life.

The most significant takeaway from this project is that digital literacy is not a single skill but an ongoing collection of competencies that must be developed, practised, and updated continuously. As a Computer Science student, I have a particular responsibility to model good digital practices and help those around me do the same. The GitHub repository created for this project will serve as the foundation of my professional digital identity for the years ahead.

## References


- Canva – Free Online Graphic Design Tool: https://www.canva.com
- GitHub – Code Hosting and Version Control: https://www.github.com
- LinkedIn – Professional Networking Platform: https://www.linkedin.com
- Kaggle – Data Science and ML Community: https://www.kaggle.com
- HackerRank – Coding Practice Platform: https://www.hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – Digital Literacy Assessment Quiz: https://forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930 (24x7, Government of India)
- VIT Bhopal University – CSE0001 Digital Literacy Course Material (2025)